



Gateshead and Newcastle Councils
Core Strategy and Urban Core Plan
Habitat Regulations Assessment

November 2013

Screening Report

Gateshead and Newcastle Councils

Habitats Regulations Assessment of the Core Strategy and Urban Core Plan for Gateshead and Newcastle

Stage 1: Screening Report

November 2013

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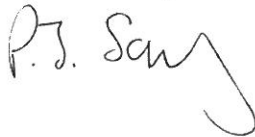
Stage 1: Screening Report

November 2013

For and on behalf of
Natural Capital Ltd.

Approved by: Dr Phil Say

Signed:



Position: Director

Date: 29.11.13

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1 INTRODUCTION

1.1 GENERAL BACKGROUND TO HABITATS REGULATIONS ASSESSMENT

The UK is bound by the terms of the EC Birds Directive and Habitats Directive¹ and the Ramsar Convention². In the UK the European Directives have been implemented through the Conservation of Habitats and Species Regulations 2010³ (the Habitats Regulations) that provide for the protection of what are termed European Sites.^{4,5} These sites include Special Areas of Conservation (SACs) designated under the Habitats Directive and Special Protection Areas (SPAs) under the Birds Directive.

The network of sites across the European Community is known as *Natura 2000*. Once established, the onus is on Member States to protect and restore the sites included in the network in accordance with the Habitat Directive's Article 6, which outlines the minimum conservation measures to be safeguarded or the Birds Directive for sites with priority bird species.

Habitats Regulations Assessment of plans that could affect SPAs or SACs is required by Article 6(3) of the European Habitats Directive.

"Any plan or project not directly connected with or necessary to the management of the site but likely to have a significant effect thereon, either individually or in combination with other plans or projects, shall be subject to Habitats Regulations Assessment of its implications for the site in view of the site's conservation objectives...."

Article 6(4) of the Habitats Directive goes on to discuss the alternative solutions, the test of 'Imperative Reasons Of Overriding Public Interest,' (IROPI) and compensatory measures:

"If, in spite of a negative assessment of the implications for the site and in the absence of alternative solutions, a plan or project must nevertheless be carried out for imperative reasons of overriding public interest, including those of social or economic nature, the Member State shall take all compensatory measures necessary to ensure that the overall coherence of Natura 2000 is protected."

The Habitats Directive applies the precautionary principle to SPAs and SACs. Plans and projects can only be permitted having ascertained that there will be no adverse effect on the integrity of the site(s) in question. The interest features of the European Sites must be maintained in "favourable condition". This means that the abundance, distribution, structure or function of the plants and animals comprising the interest features must not be adversely affected by human

¹ Council Directive on the conservation of wild birds of 2nd April 1979 (79/409/EEC) and Council Directive 92/43/EEC on the conservation of natural habitats and wild fauna and flora of 21st May 1992

² Convention on wetlands of international importance especially as waterfowl habitat, Ramsar, Iran 2nd Feb 1971.

³ The Conservation of Habitats and Species Regulations 2010

⁴ The Conservation of Habitats and Species (Amendment) Regulations 2011 – relating to protection of marine environments in inshore waters.

⁵ The Conservation of Habitats and Species (Amendment) Regulations 2012 – relating to placing new duties on public bodies to take measures to preserve, maintain and re-establish habitat for wild birds and further transpositions of the Birds Directive.

activities. Plans and projects may still be permitted if there are no alternatives to them and the IROPI test (see above) substantiates that they should go ahead. In such cases, compensation will be necessary to ensure the overall integrity of the site network.

In October 2005, the European Court of Justice ruled that land-use plans should be subject to a "Habitats Regulations Assessment" of their implications for European sites. A letter from the Office of the Deputy Prime Minister (ODPM) in March 2006 communicated this ruling to Chief Planning Officers. In addition as a matter of policy, the Government has chosen to apply the procedures on Ramsar sites and potential SPAs even though these are not classified as European sites as a matter of law. Ramsar sites (so named following the Convention on Wetlands of International Importance, held in Ramsar, Iran, 1971) are wetland sites of international importance. They are protected for their important habitats, in particular for waterbirds.

1.2 CONTEXT FOR GATESHEAD AND NEWCASTLE COUNCILS

Gateshead and Newcastle Councils have produced a joint Core Strategy and Urban Core Area Action Plan – the '*Core Strategy and Urban Core Plan for Gateshead and Newcastle*' (referred to as 'the Plan' throughout the rest of this document) that sets out the overall vision and high-level spatial strategy for their joint administrative areas until 2030.

The Councils have undertaken a sustainability appraisal and strategic environmental assessment of the Plan. As required by legislation they have also carried out the first stages of a Habitats Regulations Assessment – the Screening Stage, that will identify whether there is a need to progress to a Stage 2 Appropriate Assessment. This is considered to be important in view of the presence of a number of European and Ramsar sites in the general area and in particular the relative proximity of the Northumbria Coast SPA and Ramsar site (see Figure 2.1).

Natural Capital was invited by Gateshead and Newcastle Councils to undertake the research and provide the information so that it could, as the competent authority, carry out the Habitats Regulations Assessment.

This work draws from and builds on screening work carried out by each of the authorities (Gateshead Council and Newcastle City Council) whilst carrying out earlier work on their individual Core Strategies.^{6,7}

1.3 GUIDANCE

Early guidance on the Habitats Regulations in relation to Natura 2000 Sites was produced by English Nature in a series of guidance notes. These included one dealing specifically with Habitats Regulations Assessment⁸, one dealing with the determination of likely significant effect⁹, and a third published a little later

⁶ Screening for Habitats Regulation Assessment, Gateshead Local Development Framework Issues and Alternative Options Paper, Gateshead Council, November 2008.

⁷ Habitats Regulations Assessment Screening Opinion, Core Strategy, Local Development Framework, Newcastle City Council, January 2008.

⁸ The Habitats Regulations Assessment (Regulation 48) The Conservation (Natural Habitat &) Regulations, 1994, Habitats Regulation Guidance Note, HRGN 1, English Nature, 1997.

⁹ The Determination of Likely Significant Effect under the Conservation (Natural Habitat &) Regulations 1994, Habitats Regulation Guidance Note, HRGN 3, English Nature, 1999.

dealing with the consideration of effects of plans on European Sites either alone or in combination with other plans and programmes.¹⁰

Guidance for Habitats Regulations Assessments can also be found in a guide issued in 2000 by the European Commission – *Managing Natura 2000 Sites*¹¹. This provides a detailed guide of Article 6 and includes clarification of Habitats Regulations Assessment, conservation objectives and other important concepts within the Article.

The former ODPM and the Department of Environment, Food and Rural Affairs (DEFRA) have issued a joint circular – *Biodiversity and Geological Conservation – Statutory Obligations and their Impact within the Planning System*¹² which set out Government policy with regard to internationally designated sites and provides useful clarification on assessing effects of plans, Habitats Regulations Assessment and considering site integrity.

The Department for Communities and Local Government issued guidance in August 2006 for regional spatial strategies and local development documents on planning for the protection of European Sites and undertaking Habitats Regulations Assessment.¹³ The circular sets out the recommended methodology and provides step-by-step guidance.

The 2010 update of the legislation was accompanied by an explanatory memorandum¹⁴ setting out an explanation of the various amendments made to the 1994 Regulations, in respect of England and Wales.

1.4 METHODOLOGY AND APPROACH USED FOR THIS APPRAISAL

1.4.1 Methodology

European guidance¹⁵ on Habitats Regulations Assessment recommends a process of up to four stages:

1. **Screening:** Determining whether the plan 'in combination' is likely to have a significant effect on a European site.
2. **Appropriate Assessment:** Determining whether, in view of the site's conservation objectives, the plan 'in combination' would have an adverse effect (or risk of this) on the integrity of the site. If not the plan can proceed.
3. **Assessment of alternative solutions:** Where the plan is assessed as having an adverse effect (or risk of this) on the integrity of a site, there should be an examination of alternatives.
4. **Assessment where no alternative solutions exist:** and where adverse impacts remain.

¹⁰ Alone or in Combination, Habitats Regulations Guidance Note, HRGN 4, English Nature, 2001.

¹¹ Managing Natura 2000 Sites – The provisions of Article 6 of the Habitats' Directive 92/43/CEE, Official Publication of the European Communities, 2000.

¹² Government Circular: Biodiversity and Geological Conservation – Statutory Obligations and their Impact within the Planning System, ODPM Circular 06/2005, Defra Circular 01/2005, August 2005.

¹³ Planning for the Protection of European Sites: Habitats Regulations Assessment, Guidance for Regional Spatial Strategies and Local Development Documents, Department for Communities and Local Government, August 2006.

¹⁴ Department for Environment, Food and Rural Affairs (2010) Explanatory Memorandum to the Conservation of Habitats And Species Regulations 2010 No. 490.

¹⁵ Managing Natura 2000 Sites – The provisions of Article 6 of the Habitats' Directive 92/43/CEE, Official Publication of the European Communities, 2000.

Government guidance¹³ summarises the process into 3 main tasks:

1. Establishing the likely significant effects.
2. Carrying out the Appropriate Assessment and ascertaining the effect on site integrity.
3. Determining mitigation, alternative solutions and considering whether there are “*imperative reasons of overriding public interest*” (see Section 1.2).

Although the Habitats Regulations do not define “the integrity of the site”, paragraph 20 of Circular 06/2005¹² defines it as the ‘coherence of its ecological structure and function, across its whole area, that enables it to sustain the habitat, complex of habitats, and/or the levels of populations of the species for which it was classified’.

The methodology adopted in the present study starts with the screening stage to establish the likelihood of significant effects on European sites and the need to proceed to Appropriate Assessment.

1.4.2 Approach

The purpose of this Screening stage is, therefore, to identify the likely impacts of the Policy Options within the Plan on any of the European and Ramsar sites, either alone or in combination with other projects or plans, and to consider whether these impacts are likely to be significant.

Any identified effect that could compromise the functioning or ongoing viability of a site for its stated purpose would be defined as a ‘significant effect’. Significant effects are assessed relative to the designated interest features and conservation objectives of the European site, based on informed judgment.

If the potential for significant effects is identified through this initial stage, an assessment must then be carried out to determine whether the plan’s Policy Options would adversely affect the integrity of any site in terms of its nature conservation objectives, and whether alternatives can be adopted to ensure the plan will result in no adverse effect on the integrity of any European site. This is known as the Stage 2 Appropriate Assessment of the Habitats Regulations Assessment.

2 SCREENING

The screening process aims to be a first sieve of European and Ramsar sites that the proposed Plan policies could possibly affect, and to determine whether the plan on its own or 'in combination' with other plans is likely to cause any significant effects.

2.1 EUROPEAN SITES

Table 2.1 lists the European and Ramsar Sites that are in the general North East area. Figure 2.1 shows the location of Newcastle and Gateshead in the context of these sites and in the wider region of North East England.

The SPA sites are designated because of their important breeding birds and wintering migrants that include important species of wader. Many of the breeding birds and migrants (e.g. geese and waders) tend to move around in large flocks to feed and roost, particularly in winter. This can involve the birds moving between coast and inland sites often outside the designated European sites, sometimes to adjacent farmland and uplands. Therefore the protection of these areas will be important for protecting in turn the integrity of the SPAs.

Table 2.1 European and Ramsar Sites that could possibly be adversely affected by the Plan's Policy Options

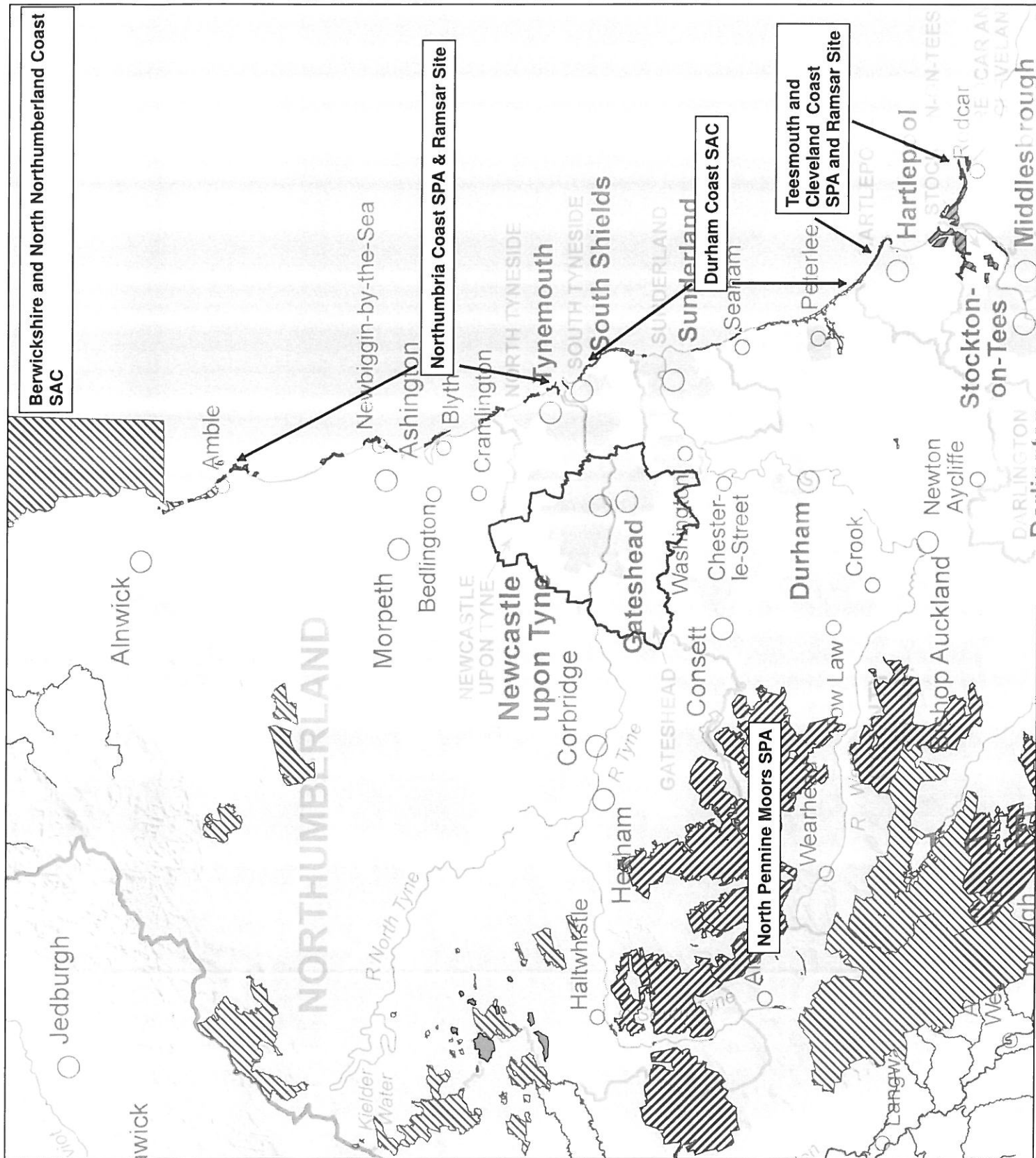
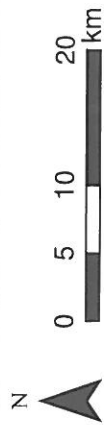
Name of Site	Approx. Distance to The Plan Boundary (km)	Reason for Designation
Berwickshire and North Northumberland Coast (SAC)	34km (Newcastle)	Mudflats and sandflats not covered by seawater at low tide Large shallow inlets and bays Reefs Submerged or partially submerged sea caves Grey seal <i>Halichoerus grypus</i>
Coquet Island (SPA)	29km (Newcastle)	48.4% of the GB breeding population of Roseate tern <i>Sterna dougallii</i> 6% of the GB breeding population of Common tern <i>Sterna hirundo</i> 1.6% of the GB breeding population of Arctic tern <i>Sterna paradisaea</i> 11.4% of the GB breeding population of Sandwich tern <i>Sterna sandvicensis</i>
Durham Coast SAC	11km (Gateshead)	Durham Coast is the only example of vegetated sea cliffs on magnesian limestone exposures in the UK. Vegetation is unique in the British Isles and consists of a complex mosaic of paramaritime, mesotrophic and calcicolous grasslands, tall-herb fen, seepage flushes and wind pruned scrub.
Farne Islands (SPA)	59km (Newcastle)	1.9% of the GB breeding population of Common tern <i>Sterna hirundo</i> 6.5% of the GB breeding population of Arctic tern <i>Sterna paradisaea</i> 14.8% of the GB breeding population of Sandwich tern <i>Sterna sandvicensis</i>
Ford Moss (SAC)	67km (Newcastle)	Active raised bogs
Harbottle Moors (SAC)	38km (Newcastle)	European dry heaths
Holburn Lake and Moss (SPA) and Ramsar Site	62km (Newcastle)	Lowland raised mire 2.2% of the population of Greylag goose <i>Anser anser</i> Inland roost for wildfowl during unfavourable weather conditions

Name of Site	Approx. Distance to The Plan Boundary (km)	Reason for Designation
Lindisfarne (SPA)	59km (Newcastle)	Significant breeding populations of vulnerable species listed in Annex I (Article 4.1) Birds Directive: Little tern <i>Sterna albifrons</i> Roseate tern <i>Sterna dougallii</i> Whooper swan <i>Cygnus cygnus</i> Bar-tailed godwit <i>Limosa lapponica</i> Golden plover <i>Pluvialis apricaria</i> Significant number of over wintering migratory species (Article 4.2) Birds Directive: Wigeon <i>Anas penelope</i> Greylag goose <i>Anser anser</i> Pale-bellied brent goose <i>Branta bernicla hrota</i> Sanderling <i>Calidris alba</i> Dunlin <i>Calidris alpina alpina</i> Ringed plover <i>Charadrius hiaticula</i> Long-tailed duck <i>Clangula hyemalis</i> Red-breasted serrat <i>Mergus serrator</i> Grey plover <i>Pluvialis squatarola</i> Common eider <i>Somateria mollissima</i> Shelduck <i>Tadorna tadorna</i>
Lindisfarne Ramsar Site		Ramsar criterion 6 – species/populations of the above species occurring at levels of international importance Intertidal flats, large area of saltmarsh and major sand dune system with well developed dune slacks Assemblages of international importance of 44970 waterfowl
Newham Fen (SAC)	54km (Newcastle)	Alkaline fens
Northumbria Coast SPA	9km (Newcastle)	1.7% of the GB breeding population of Little tern <i>Sterna albifrons</i> 2.6% of the East Atlantic Flyway population of Turnstone <i>Arenaria interpres</i> 1.6 % of the East Atlantic Flyway population of Purple sandpiper <i>Calidris maritima</i>
Northumbria Coast Ramsar Site		Ramsar criterion 6 – species/populations of the above species occurring at levels of international importance
North Northumberland Dunes (SAC)	64km (Newcastle)	Embryonic shifting dunes Shifting dunes along the shoreline with <i>Ammophila arenaria</i> ('white dunes') Fixed dunes with herbaceous vegetation ('grey dunes') Dunes with <i>Salix repens ssp. argentea</i> (<i>Salicion arenariae</i>) Humid dune slacks <i>Petalwort Petalophyllum ralfsii</i>
North Pennine Dales Meadows (SAC)	39km (Gateshead)	Mountain hay meadows <i>Molinia</i> meadows
North Pennine Moors (SAC)	10km (Gateshead)	European dry heaths, blanket bogs, petrifying springs with tufa formation siliceous rocky slopes, old sessile oak woods, Northern Atlantic wet heaths, Calaminarian grasslands, siliceous alpine and boreal grasslands, semi-natural dry grasslands and scrubland, alkaline fens
North Pennine Moors (SPA)	9km (Newcastle)	Annex I species: Hen Harrier, Merlin, Peregrine Falcon, Golden Plover
River Tweed SAC	43km (Newcastle)	Tidal rivers, estuaries, mud flats, sand flats, lagoons and inland waters (standing and running). Bogs, marshes, water fringed vegetation, fens and broad leaved deciduous woodland Water courses of plain to montane levels with <i>Ranunculus fluitantis</i> and <i>Callitriche-Batrachion</i> vegetation Atlantic salmon <i>Salmo salar</i> Otter <i>Lutra lutra</i> Sea lamprey <i>Petromyzon marinus</i> Brook lamprey <i>Lampetra planeri</i> River lamprey <i>Lampetra fluviatilis</i>
Simonside Hills (SAC)	27km (Newcastle)	European dry heaths Blanket bogs
Tweed Estuary (SAC)	80km (Newcastle)	Estuaries, mudflats and sandflats not covered by seawater at low tide Sea lamprey <i>Petromyzon marinus</i> River lamprey <i>Lampetra fluviatilis</i>

Figure 2.1: Natura 2000 Sites in Proximity to the Area Covered by the Core Strategy and Urban Core Plan

Key

-  Core Strategy Boundary
-  Ramsar Site
-  Special Area of Conservation
-  Special Protection Area



2.2 THE PLAN: POSSIBLE EFFECTS

2.2.1 The Plan's Spatial Strategy and Strategic Policies

In terms of future significant development, the Plan provides for:

- building 30,000 new homes;
- a minimum of 150 hectares of employment land, providing a minimum of 512,000m² of new office space, primarily in the Urban Core;
- focusing employment uses and economic regeneration activities within allocated employment areas (Urban Core, Team Valley, Walker Riverside, Follingsby, Newcastle International Airport);
- development within rural areas and villages particularly where additional development will assist in securing their long-term sustainability;
- the encouragement of tourism, visitor and culture-led regeneration;
- additional sports and recreation related facilities supported in appropriate locations;
- the encouragement of new town centre retail led regeneration, focusing on the centres of Newcastle and Gateshead; and
- supporting programmes of improvement, renewal and replacement to regenerate existing neighbourhoods.

2.2.2 Possible Effects

The more "generic" operations and actions that would be likely to cause an effect on an SPA and would therefore need to be considered within the Habitats Regulations Assessment are summarised in *Table 2.2*.

Table 2.2 Generic Actions that can Cause Effects on European Sites

Operations Likely to Cause Deterioration or Disturbance	Actions that can Cause the Effect
Physical loss	• Removal or destruction of habitat and/or species of interest • Smothering
Physical damage	• Changes in land management practices • Prevention of natural erosion as in coastal defences, flood defences • Mineral extraction • Water abstraction • Recreational pressure – trampling, erosion etc • Drainage – increased run-off and land form disturbance can affect hydrology and groundwater of wetland sites • Litter – garbage, plastics, nets and lines affecting birds and animals
Non-physical disturbance	• Noise/ visual presence – recreational or industrial • Transport/navigation • Disturbance causing species to relocate, such as bird species impacting on feeding availability and time, and the energy loss when birds have to move rather than feed in winter
Toxic (and non-toxic) contamination	• Nutrient enrichment • Changes in turbidity (e.g. flood defence) • Changes in water level (e.g. water abstraction) • Changes in salinity (e.g. water abstraction) • Agricultural run-off
Biological disturbance	• Introduction of non-native species • Selective extraction of species

In carrying out a screening analysis of the Plan the possible effects (direct and indirect) of policy options on designated sites throughout the region are summarised in *Table 2.3*.

Table 2.3 Summary of Activities that can Cause Deterioration or Disturbance to European and Ramsar Sites

Activities	Direct Effects	Indirect Effects
Land take	Direct land take from within a European site has the potential to disturb, remove and replace habitats and associated flora and fauna possibly including qualifying and protected species at sites of development through e.g. site clearance and construction activities	- Land take from nearby leading to disturbance and downstream contamination affecting habitats, flora and fauna within a European site - Land take that affects important feeding and roosting sites (out with of the site boundary) of migratory bird species that feature as qualifying species within European and Ramsar sites
Provision of water services (abstraction and treatment)	- Deterioration in the quality of controlled waters (such as the River Tyne) due to strain placed on wastewater treatment capacity as a result of increased development - Location, construction and maintenance of infrastructure involved in the provision of water services	Impacts on hydrological regimes of European sites due to an increased demand for water abstraction and wastewater treatment in those parts of the region targeted for increases in housing and business premises development
Construction activities	Uncontrolled activities or emergencies resulting in a pollution incident reaching a European site	
Traffic levels and congestion	- Increases in road traffic and congestion will inevitably lead to increases in emissions and associated atmospheric pollution that can have a direct effect on sensitive plant species e.g. lichens - Increased traffic creates noise, vibration and other nuisances that could disturb bird and animal species	- Increased traffic emissions adding to the burden of CO₂ that will contribute to climate change - Climate change can have a detrimental effect on biodiversity (temperature changes, droughts and flooding)
General urbanisation	More development and more activity could lead to more noise, more clutter, more light pollution and generally more disturbance within the environment	Pressures on greenbelt leading to gradual loss of land and potential coastal squeeze
Increased tourism and recreation		Could lead to more visits into or near to the European sites with consequential noise, disturbance (vehicles, cycles, people, and dogs) trampling and litter all of which could affect sensitive habitats and bird species

2.3 SCREENING AND POTENTIAL EFFECTS

Annex A shows the rapid screening tables used for assessing the potential for impact of the following strategic policies on the seventeen SPA and SAC sites considered within the assessment:

- 4 Strategic Spatial Policies – CS1 to CS4
- 17 Strategic Policies – CS5 – CS21
- 17 Urban Core Policies – UC1 – UC17

Annex B shows the rapid screening table used for assessing the potential for impact of the following policies:

- 17 Sub Area and Sites Policies for Newcastle
- 18 Sub Area and Sites Policies for Gateshead

Annex C shows the results of the screening process undertaken in more detail for each of the European sites considered.

The results of the screening exercise are discussed in *Section 3* and the key conclusions drawn are presented in *Section 4*.

2.4 POSSIBLE IN-COMBINATION EFFECTS

The guidance¹⁶ indicates that it is essential to consider possible developments in adjoining local authority areas in order to assess whether there could be any “in-combination” effects caused by the cumulative effects of additional development projects, plans and programmes. In *Table D1* in *Annex D* are included strategies or plans that propose some possible developments in adjoining local authority areas that would need to be taken into consideration. This information has been sourced from either discussions with respective planning officers or from reviews of relevant local authority Core Strategies and Local Plans or a combination of both. The implications of these other plans and strategies that are currently at various different stages in the planning process are considered in *Section 3* of this report.

A summary of possible in-combination effects that would be important in the context of the Habitats Regulations Assessment is given in *Table D2* in *Annex D*.

¹⁶ Habitats Regulations Assessment of Plans: Discussion Paper, Scott Wilson *et al.*, June 2006

3 DISCUSSION

The discussion focuses on four key areas:

- site integrity of European sites;
- possible tourism and recreation effects;
- water resources; and
- future proposed developments at Metrogreen and Callerton.

3.1 SITE INTEGRITY OF EUROPEAN SITES

There are no European sites within the administrative areas of either Gateshead or Newcastle and therefore none within the combined Plan area.

On the basis of the screening process carried out (see *Annex C*) a number of conclusions can be drawn, these are that:

- none of the policies within the Plan would generate a 'likely significant effect' on any of these sites;
- all of the seventeen European sites (three of which are also classified as Ramsar sites) can be screened out from the need for further assessment.

However it was noted in previous screening work carried out by Gateshead Council⁶ that because two of the European sites (one in relative close proximity) support wintering migratory wading bird populations that are highly mobile, and because the Tyne Estuary, including intertidal mud and adjacent land within Gateshead, is also used by migratory waders, it was considered necessary to consider this issue in more detail.

3.1.1 Northumbria Coast SPA

The closest site to both Council areas is the Northumbria Coast SPA, which at its closest point, is over 8 kilometres from Gateshead Council's boundary and over 9 kilometres from Newcastle Council's boundary. This site is designated in part for its wintering migratory wading bird populations of purple sandpiper (*Calidris maritima*) and turnstone (*Arenaria interpres*). These occur only rarely and in insignificant numbers in the administrative areas of Gateshead and Newcastle⁶ being confined to coastal rocky shores and high tide roosts on or close to the coast. The only potential indirect impact on these populations would therefore be possible pollution or sediment disturbance of the estuary. However this potential effect would be of no serious consequence to these particular waders since they are species typical of rocky coasts that do not feed on mud flats.

3.1.2 North Pennine Moors SPA

More remote from the Tyne Estuary is the North Pennine Moors SPA. This area is designated as an SPA because it contains habitat that supports the Annex I species hen harrier, merlin, peregrine falcon, and golden plover. The latter is an upland breeding wader that winters at lower levels and could therefore potentially utilise the intertidal mud and adjacent areas of the estuary within the Gateshead and Newcastle areas. The closest mud flats in Gateshead and Newcastle are over 22 kilometres from the nearest point of this SPA.

There is limited data on the golden plover and its movements in the area but observations to date indicate that it arrives in significant numbers on the estuary relatively late in the autumn, which suggests that these are birds from further afield than the North Pennines, probably from Scandinavia.⁶

Alongside the issue of possible effects on specific wintering migratory wading bird populations, it was also considered important to consider the potential effects of increased tourism and recreation in the general area and what if any effects on European sites this might generate. The screening of sites summarised in *Annex C* did not establish any likely significant effects, however the issue is discussed further here.

- Would this lead to more visitors and foot fall onto the coast?
- Would this lead to encroachments of development onto the coast?
- Would this generate a cumulative effect in combination with policies of other local authorities that aim to encourage more tourism and recreation in the area?

Policy CS8 Leisure, Culture and Tourism

1. Focusing leisure, cultural and tourist attractions in the Urban Core and at sustainably accessible locations.
2. Supporting visitor attractions and accommodation in the Rural and Villages Area which are sustainably accessible and do not undermine the character of the area.

Any developments that might increase recreational use and therefore have the potential to increase human disturbance along the riverside, will need to take into account the nature conservation importance of the estuary. High tide roosts

for waders are clearly important and run the risk of becoming an increasingly scarce resource as a result of the gradual development of sections of the river bank. Major known roosts in the Plan area, however lie mainly, if not entirely, within protected sites, notably for example in the Gateshead area at Dunston Staiths and Timber Beach within the River Tyne Tidal Mud, Local Wildlife Site (LWS) and at Shibdon Pond SSSI. Although it should be remembered that other roosts may be unrecorded.⁶

The protection of the riverside area was formerly addressed in policies within the Unitary Development Plans (UDP) of the two authorities. Policies were developed for example within the Gateshead UDP that provided protection for the River Tyne Corridor with safeguards to a strip of between 10 and 30 metres in width for a riverside route for pedestrians and cyclists, subject to the conservation of wildlife interest, in accordance with other policies in the Plan. This provided a landscaped setting for the route enabling natural screening to be created on the more sensitive sections of the riverbank. In the Gateshead area this approach, developed in consultation with the RSPB in the early 1990s, was used successfully on the Costco section of the riverbank, north of the Metrocentre, and has been followed on the Staiths South Bank development.⁶

More recently the northern half of the River Tyne has been designated as a Local Wildlife Site by Newcastle Council and the southern section is due to be designated by both Gateshead and South Tyneside Councils in the near future. These initiatives will provide further protection for the riverside area.

It is envisaged that these approaches to protection and in the treatment of development on the riverbank will be continued to ensure a balance between recreation and nature conservation. This is set out currently in Policy CS18 (see Box 2) that focuses on green infrastructure and the natural environment.

Box 2 Policy CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment

A high quality and comprehensive framework of interconnected Green Infrastructure that offers ease of movement and an appealing natural environment for people and wildlife will be achieved by:

1. Maintaining, protecting and enhancing the integrity, connectivity, multifunctionality and accessibility of the Strategic Green Infrastructure Network.
2. Protection, enhancement and management of Green Infrastructure assets which include:
 - i. Biodiversity and geodiversity assets, including designated sites, designated wildlife corridors and priority habitats and species,
 - ii. Distinctive landscape character, recognising the particular importance of our rivers and topography, and
 - iii. Trees, woodland and hedgerows.
3. Addressing gaps in the network and making improvements in Opportunity Areas.
4. Improving and extending linkages to and within the Strategic Green Infrastructure Network.
5. Protecting and enhancing open spaces, sport and recreational facilities in accordance with agreed standards in line with National Policy.
6. Improving access to, along and onto the River Tyne and tributaries, without adversely impacting on the local ecology or damaging the river banks.

This policy includes clauses that provide protection for the River Tyne, its banks and the natural landscaping along the river (in particular Clause 6). Clause 2 will help to ensure that new development does not indirectly or in combination with other plans and programmes in the area, pose a threat or lead to adverse impacts on designated sites and biodiversity in the area.

The Core Strategies of other local authorities in the area also include policies that are designed to provide similar layers of protection for green infrastructure, local biodiversity and the risks of indirect effects on designated areas.

3.3 WATER RESOURCES

With the planned increase in housing over the development period of the Plan it is conceivable that this could put strains on both the supply of water and its treatment. As raised in Table 2.3 this in turn could raise questions as to whether there would be any impacts on the hydrological regimes of European sites due to an increased demand for water abstraction and wastewater treatment in those parts of the region targeted for increases in housing and business premises development. Any drop in the standards of water treatment could bring about deterioration in the quality of controlled waters such as the River Tyne particularly if any undue strain is placed on wastewater treatment capacity as a result of increased development. This in turn could conceivably affect sediment movements and sedimentation rates in the lower estuary that in turn could affect feeding behaviour of waders in the Northumbria Coast SPA.

The Councils have liaised with Northumbria Water over these potential issues and have been assured that:

- Any potential future growth in demand for water as indicated by the figures for new housing will be more than met by the existing capacity of Kielder Water.¹⁷
- The recent upgrading of the sewage and wastewater treatment facilities along the River Tyne will be able to handle projected increases in housing and should therefore ensure that there is no deterioration of water quality in the River Tyne due to future development.¹⁸

This confirms that significant effects on European sites caused by provision of water resources and services associated with policies within the Plan are not an issue. There is no justification for undertaking more detailed assessment of any sites in relation to this particular issue.

3.4 FUTURE PROPOSED DEVELOPMENTS AT METROGREEN AND CALLERTON

Metrogreen

Metrogreen is regarded as a longer-term aspiration due to the complex nature of the area concerned. The area is associated with tidal flooding from the River Tyne, fluvial flooding from the River Derwent and some parts suffer drainage problems and the gathering of surface water. A Flood Management Plan has been prepared to provide a better understanding of different flood mitigation options, including viability and long term sustainability.

¹⁷ Gateshead Council *Pers comm*

¹⁸ Gateshead Council *Pers comm*

The Flood Management Plan has concluded that a comprehensive defence scheme will be needed. The preferred approach involves the creation of a soft landscaped embankment set back from the River Tyne frontage or strategic river front land raising, incorporating green infrastructure. This would complement the Metrogreen Surface Water Management Plan's recommended initiative of incorporating Sustainable Drainage System (SuDS) measures to mitigate surface water runoff by restoring a critical land drainage network conveying the surface water over land into the River Tyne and River Derwent through a series of swales, open water channels and a series of strategic attenuation storage areas (ponds, wetlands/detention basins).

Developments here would have implications for the River Tyne and future developers will be required to address issues such as protecting water quality and mitigating potential impacts on ecology through rigorous EIA. No significant effects would be anticipated on European sites but there would be a need to assess the effects of future development on waders and in particular high tide roost areas.

Lower, Middle and Upper Callerton

This significant development is planned for an area that will include greenbelt land. Information available on the proposed site indicates that the greenbelt land is mainly composed of arable fields with no significant ecological interest. Any areas noted to be of wildlife interest are to be retained and enhanced. There are a number of small ponds in the area but those likely to be affected by developments are not known to support protected species. If any protected species are present these will need to be dealt with through the EIA process and adequate mitigation identified. Policy CS17 (Flood Risk and Water Management) has a Clause 1 (iv) that prioritises the use of Sustainable Drainage Systems (SuDS) in new developments because of the multifunctional benefits to water quality, green space and habitat enhancement that they bring. The incorporation of these measures into housing developments at these sites will bring biodiversity enhancement opportunities.

There are no known sites of importance to migratory or overwintering populations of birds within the proposed area for development.¹⁹

3.5 REVISED GREEN BELT BOUNDARIES

Consultation with Council Ecologists has confirmed that the revised green-belt boundaries and land allocations that appear in the relevant policies within the Plan will not generate significant effects on European sites. Most of the adjustments that have been made to accommodate housing needs are associated with medium grade agricultural land (mainly arable) with low ecological interest. None of the sites have been identified as supporting SPA species for either roosting or feeding purposes.

3.6 SUB-AREA AND SITE-SPECIFIC POLICIES

Consultation with Council Biodiversity Officers also confirmed that the sub-area and site-specific policies that feature within the Plan will not generate significant effects on European sites. In terms of local sites, Gateshead and Newcastle's consultation process with the Biodiversity Officers meant proposals which would have had the potential to impact on local designated sites or wildlife interests

¹⁹ Newcastle City Council Biodiversity Officer *Pers Comm*

had their boundaries reduced or were scoped out altogether. Furthermore, most sub-area and site-specific policies have clauses which support the retention, protection and/or creation of green infrastructure and features of wildlife interest.

3.7 POSSIBLE IN-COMBINATION EFFECTS

The possibilities of in-combination effects are considered in Annex D. It is concluded that given the discussion in Sections 3.1 and 3.2 above and the many policies formulated by neighbouring authorities for the protection of the European sites and for the protection and enhancement of environmental assets and green infrastructure in general within the region (see Table D1 in Annex D), that the Plan will not in-combination generate likely significant effects on any European site.

CONCLUSIONS

- The potential effects on Natura 2000 sites identified in this assessment arising from policies in the Plan are in all instances indirect and not considered to be significant. They therefore do not pose a threat to the site integrity or to the achievement of conservation objectives of any of the European sites considered.
- Given the limited effects identified as arising from the Plan, it is considered that its contribution to possible 'in combination' effects will be adequately mitigated against by policies within the Plan designed to protect these designated sites as well as green infrastructure and the natural environment. This will be strengthened further by the mitigation proposed by the policies of the neighbouring authorities.
- It is considered that the policy framework and supporting text of the Plan provides an appropriate level of protection for Natura 2000 sites against any possible effects arising from the proposed policies.
- The two Councils have therefore determined, based on this screening, that the implementation of the Plan will have no significant effect on any of the European Natura 2000 sites.
- A further appraisal, the Appropriate Assessment, that would consider significant adverse impacts caused by the proposed Plan and its policies, is not therefore required.

ANNEX A

SUMMARY RAPID SCREENING TABLE FOR PLAN STRATEGIC POLICIES CS1 – CS21 and UC1 – UC17

A1 This annex reports the screening undertaken of the strategic policies within the Plan against the various European Natura 2000 sites in the general area.

A screening system was developed and used based on the following scale of effects.

✓✓	Clear strong positive effects
✓	Broadly supportive
0	Neutral or no discernible effect
x	Likely negative effect
?	Uncertain effect

The screening is summarised in the following table that lists the policies and presents the findings of the screening in relation to each of the Natura 2000 sites.

To carry out the screening process, a set of questions based on key criteria that relate to the qualifying interests and integrity of the sites was established to aid in the decision making process for assessing whether the policies would impact on site integrity. The questions are summarised in the following table.

Key Questions used in the Screening Process	
Will the policy cause physical loss or damage to the European site?	
Will the policy cause pollution to land, sea or air that might impact upon the qualifying features?	
Will the policy restrict the capacity to meet conservation objectives?	
Will the policy disrupt those factors that help maintain the favourable conditions of the site?	
Will the policy interfere with the balance, distribution and density of key flora and fauna that are the indicators of the favourable condition of the site?	
Will the policy increase disturbance close to the site?	
Will the policy encourage further access to the site by the public and their pets?	
Will the policy result in the removal of roosting grounds?	
Will the policy cause an increase in the scale or nature of development near the site, which could cause an impact on the site and affect site integrity?	
Will the policy change the type of development currently near the site that could lead to future impacts on the site?	
Will the policy affect areas utilised by qualifying bird species outside of the SPA?	
Will the policy encourage the encroachment on bird flight paths or affect their habitat?	
Will the policy increase developmental creep that could attract other types of development that might be more likely to have an impact on the site?	
Will the policy increase the likelihood of coastal or foreshore developments?	

Table A.1: Screening of Strategic Policies against European Natura 2000 sites

SPA and SAC Sites																		
The Plan Policies																		
Spatial Strategy																		
CS1: Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth		Berwickshire and North Northumberland Coast SAC	Coquet Island SPA	Durham Coast SAC	Farne Islands SPA	Ford Moss SAC	Harbottle Moors SAC	Holburn Lake and Moss SPA	Lindisfarne SPA	Newham Fen SAC	Northumbria Coast SPA	North Northumberland Dunes SAC	North Pennine Dales Meadows SAC	North Pennine Moors SAC	North Pennine Moors SPA	River Tweed SAC	Simonside Hills SAC	Tweed Estuary SAC
CS2: Spatial Strategy for Urban Core		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
CS3: Spatial Strategy for Neighbourhood Area		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
CS4: Spatial Strategy for Rural and Villages Area		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Strategic Policies																		
CS5: Employment and Economic Growth Priorities		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
CS6: Employment Land		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
CS7: Retail and Centres		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
CS8: Leisure, Culture and Tourism		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
CS9: Existing Communities		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
CS10: Delivering New Homes		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
CS11: Providing a Range and Choice of Housing		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

SPA and SAC Sites		Berwickshire and North Northumberland Coast SAC	Coquet Island SPA	Durham Coast SAC	Farne Islands SPA	Ford Moss SAC	Harbottle Moors SAC	Holburn Lake and Moss SPA	Lindisfarne SPA	Newham Fen SAC	Northumbria Coast SPA	North Northumberland Dunes SAC	North Pennine Dales Meadows SAC	North Pennine Moors SAC	North Pennine Moors SPA	River Tweed SAC	Simonside Hills SAC	Tweed Estuary SAC
The Plan Policies																		
CS12: Gypsies, Travellers and Travelling Show People		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
CS13: Transport		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
CS14: Wellbeing and Health		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
CS15: Place Making		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
CS16: Climate Change		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
CS17: Flood Risk and Water Management		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	✓	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	✓	0	0	0	✓	0	0	0
CS19: Green Belt		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
CS20: Minerals		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
CS21: Waste		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
CS27: Infrastructure and Developer Contributions		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Urban Core Policies																		
UC1: Offices and Business Development		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

SPA and SAC Sites		Berwickshire and North Northumberland Coast SAC	Coquet Island SPA	Durham Coast SAC	Farne Islands SPA	Ford Moss SAC	Harbottle Moors SAC	Holburn Lake and Moss SPA	Lindisfarne SPA	Newham Fen SAC	Northumbria Coast SPA	North Northumberland Dunes SAC	North Pennine Dales Meadows SAC	North Pennine Moors SAC	North Pennine Moors SPA	River Tweed SAC	Simonside Hills SAC	Tweed Estuary SAC
The Plan Policies																		
UC2: New Retail (A1) in Newcastle and Gateshead		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
UC3: Leisure, Culture and Tourism		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
UC4: Homes		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
UC5: Primary and Secondary Pedestrian Routes		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
UC6: Cycling		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
UC7: Public Transport		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
UC8: Freight and Servicing		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
UC9: General Traffic		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
UC10: Car Parking		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
UC11: Gateways and Arrival Points		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
UC12: Urban Design		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

SPA and SAC Sites		Berwickshire and North Northumberland Coast SAC	Coquet Island SPA	Durham Coast SAC	Farne Islands SPA	Ford Moss SAC	Harbottle Moors SAC	Holburn Lake and Moss SPA	Lindisfarne SPA	Newham Fen SAC	Northumbria Coast SPA	North Northumberland Dunes SAC	North Pennine Dales Meadows SAC	North Pennine Moors SAC	North Pennine Moors SPA	River Tweed SAC	Simonside Hills SAC	Tweed Estuary SAC
The Plan Policies																		
UC13: Respecting and Managing Views Within, from and Into Urban Core		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
UC14: Heritage		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
UC15: Urban Green Infrastructure		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
UC16: Public Realm		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
UC17: Public Art		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

ANNEX B

SUMMARY RAPID SCREENING TABLE FOR SUB-AREA AND SITE POLICIES

B1 This annex reports the screening undertaken of the Sub-Area and Site policies within the Plan against the various European Natura 2000 sites in the general area.

A screening system was developed and used based on the following scale of effects.

✓✓	Clear strong positive effects
✓	Broadly supportive
0	Neutral or no discernible effect
x	Likely negative effect
?	Uncertain effect

The screening is summarised in the following table that lists the policies and presents the findings of the screening in relation to each of the Natura 2000 sites.

To carry out the screening process, a set of questions based on key criteria that relate to the qualifying interests and integrity of the sites was established to aid in the decision making process for assessing whether the policies would impact on site integrity. The questions are summarised in the following table.

Key Questions used in the Screening Process
Will the policy cause physical loss or damage to the European site?
Will the policy cause pollution to land, sea or air that might impact upon the qualifying features?
Will the policy restrict the capacity to meet conservation objectives?
Will the policy disrupt those factors that help maintain the favourable conditions of the site?
Will the policy interfere with the balance, distribution and density of key flora and fauna that are the indicators of the favourable condition of the site?
Will the policy increase disturbance close to the site?
Will the policy encourage further access to the site by the public and their pets?
Will the policy result in the removal of roosting grounds?
Will the policy cause an increase in the scale or nature of development near the site, which could cause an impact on the site and affect site integrity?
Will the policy change the type of development currently near the site that could lead to future impacts on the site?
Will the policy affect areas utilised by qualifying bird species outside of the SPA?
Will the policy encourage the encroachment on bird flight paths or affect their habitat?
Will the policy increase developmental creep that could attract other types of development that might be more likely to have an impact on the site?
Will the policy increase the likelihood of coastal or foreshore developments?

SPA and SAC Sites		Sub-Areas and Sites Policies																
		Berwickshire and North Northumberland Coast SAC	Coquet Island SPA	Durham Coast SAC	Farne Islands SPA	Ford Moss SAC	Harbottle Moors SAC	Holburn Lake and Moss SPA	Lindisfarne SPA	Newham Fen SAC	Northumbria Coast SPA	North Northumberland Dunes SAC	North Pennine Dales Meadows SAC	North Pennine Moors SAC	North Pennine Moors SPA	River Tweed SAC	Simonside Hills SAC	Tweed Estuary SAC
NN3: Newbiggin Hall		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
NN4: Newcastle Great Park		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
KEA1: Newcastle International Airport		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
NV1: Dinnington		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
NV2: Hazlerigg and Wideopen		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
NV3: Throckley		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Gateshead																		
GC1: Gateshead Central Sub-Area		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
GC2: Gateshead Central Development Opportunity Sites		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
SG1: Southern Gateway Sub-Area		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
SG2: The Exemplar Neighbourhood Key Site		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
SG3: Southern Gateway Development Opportunity Sites		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
QB1: Quays and Baltic Sub-Area		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
QB2: Gateshead Quays Key Site		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

SPA and SAC Sites		Berwickshire and North Northumberland Coast SAC	Coquet Island SPA	Durham Coast SAC	Farne Islands SPA	Ford Moss SAC	Harbottle Moors SAC	Holburn Lake and Moss SPA	Lindisfarne SPA	Newham Fen SAC	Northumbria Coast SPA	North Northumberland Dunes SAC	North Pennine Dales Meadows SAC	North Pennine Moors SAC	North Pennine Moors SPA	River Tweed SAC	Simonside Hills SAC	Tweed Estuary SAC
Sub-Areas and Sites Policies																		
QB3: Quays and Baltic Development Opportunity Sites		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
AOC2: Metrogreen		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
GN1: Dunston Hill		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
GV1: Chopwell		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
GV2: Crawcrook		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
GV3: Highfield		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
GV4: High Spen		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
GV5: Kibblesworth		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
GV6: Ryton		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
GV7: Sunnyside		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
EGA: South of Follingsby Lane		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
DEL1: Infrastructure and Developer Contributions		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

ANNEX C

DETAILED SCREENING TABLE FOR PLAN POLICIES

Table C1 Screening the European and Ramsar Sites Against Plan Policies

Site	Qualifying Features and Conservation Objectives	Key Environmental Conditions Supporting Site Integrity and Site Vulnerability	Likely significant effect on European Sites	Site screened in or out?
Berwickshire and North Northumberland Coast (SAC)	Qualifying features Mudflats and sandflats not covered by seawater at low tide. Large shallow inlets and bays. Reefs. Submerged or partially submerged sea caves Grey seal <i>Halichoerus grypus</i>. Conservation Objectives To maintain in favourable condition the habitats and the above qualifying features as listed above, in particular the fixed dunes with herbaceous vegetation, the embryonic shifting dunes, and the shifting dunes along the shoreline. To also include the intertidal mud and sandflats not covered by sea water at low tide as well as the rocky shores, reefs and eelgrass beds.	Key Environmental Conditions • Extensive and diverse stretch of coastline. • Areas characterised by extensive areas of clean sand. • Sand and mud flats. • Salt marsh and eelgrass beds. • Subtidal rocky reefs and their rich marine communities, together with the wide variety of associated littoral reefs. • Wide range of physical conditions on the area, from wave-exposed locations on the open coast, through more sheltered reefs within bays, to those exposed to strong tidal streams in sounds and off headlands. • Diverse range of rock types, including soft limestones and hard volcanic rock. Site Vulnerability • Rocky reef and sea cave communities are sensitive to operations that may result in their damage or removal e.g. from trawling, dredging, anchoring and coastal development or from contamination by oil or sewage. • Features found on sand and mud flats such as eel grass and mussel beds and associated animals that live in the sediment are sensitive to removal activities (e.g. trawling, dredging and coastal defence works) and contamination by oil, chemical or sewage discharges. • Threats to all of this can also come from recreational use, fisheries and waste water discharges.	• No direct or indirect significant effects from the Plan predicted for this SAC. • The Plan includes Policy CS8 'Leisure, Culture and Tourism'. The implementation of such a policy may result in additional traffic and associated disturbance in the general North East area. At this stage this is a strategic general policy with a statement of intent that is not site-specific, however the policy does state that developments will be focused primarily within the Urban Core. This will encourage the focus of movement, tourism activity and footfall within this urban area as opposed to the wider coastal fringe. The policy also goes on to state that development will not be considered in rural areas if it would undermine the character and environment of the area. • In Chapter 12 of the Plan called 'People and Place' there is a section that focuses on 'Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment' and within this is Policy CS18 on 'Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment' that recognises the importance of designated sites and includes measures for protecting and enhancing biodiversity. • The policies of other local authorities in the area to promote tourism could possibly have cumulative effects in terms of additional visitor activity and potential disturbance, but this has not been measured and the impact is uncertain. Notwithstanding this the Core Strategies of other local authorities recognise the potential for such cumulative effects and have included policies and provisions for protecting sites and conserving and where possible enhancing biodiversity.	Screened out

Site	Qualifying Features and Conservation Objectives	Key Environmental Conditions Supporting Site Integrity and Site Vulnerability	Likely significant effect on European Sites	Site screened in or out?
Coquet Island (SPA)	Qualifying features 48.4% of the GB breeding population of Roseate tern <i>Sterna dougallii</i> 6% of the GB breeding population of Common tern <i>Sterna hirundo</i> 1.6% of the GB breeding population of Arctic tern <i>Sterna paradisaea</i> 11.4% of the GB breeding population of Sandwich tern <i>Sterna sandvicensis</i> Conservation Objectives To maintain, in favourable condition, the habitats for the populations of migratory bird species and breeding seabird assemblage of European importance with particular reference to off shore islands.	Key Environmental Conditions - Predominantly marine areas with sea inlets and islands. - Intertidal rock and sediments. - Sub-tidal rock including rocky reefs. - Includes areas of improved grassland Site Vulnerability - Rocky reef areas are sensitive to operations that may result in their damage or removal e.g. from anchoring and any coastal disturbance around the island or from contamination by oil or sewage. - There are thin soils in places beneath the improved grassland areas which are easily disturbed by rabbits and puffins, which has led to concern over vegetation loss and subsequent erosion. - Terns are vulnerable to disturbance from tourists in the summer leading to reduced breeding success. - The site is managed by the RSPB as a nature reserve and is not currently open to visitors.	- No direct or indirect significant effects from the Plan predicted for this SPA. - Although there is a possibility that Policy CS8 that supports the further development of tourism and recreation together with those of other local authorities could increase the number of visitors and associated footfall in the general Northumberland area, this in itself would not be expected to significantly adversely affect the qualifying features and site integrity of this SPA. - Also the fact that the site is managed by the RSPB and is not open to visitors at the moment adds a further layer of protection.	Screened out
Durham Coast (SAC)	Qualifying features Durham Coast is the only example of vegetated sea cliffs on magnesian limestone exposures in the UK. Vegetation is unique in the British Isles and consists of a complex mosaic of paramarlime, mesotrophic and calcicolous grasslands, tall-herb fen, seepage flushes and wind pruned scrub. Conservation Objectives To maintain in favourable conditions the vegetated sea cliffs of the Atlantic and Baltic	Key Environmental Conditions - The communities present on the sea cliffs are largely maintained by natural processes including exposure to sea spray, erosion and slippage of the magnesian limestone bedrock and overlying glacial drifts as well as localised flushing by calcareous water. Site Vulnerability - Erosion of vegetation.	- No direct or indirect significant effects from the Plan predicted for this SAC. - The Plan includes Policy CS8 'Leisure, Culture and Tourism'. The implementation of such a policy may result in additional traffic and associated disturbance in the general North East area. At this stage this is a strategic general policy with a statement of intent that is not site-specific, however the policy does state that developments will be focused primarily within the Urban Core. This will encourage the focus of movement, tourism activity and footfall within this urban area as opposed to the wider	Screened out

Site	Qualifying Features and Conservation Objectives	Key Environmental Conditions Supporting Site Integrity and Site Vulnerability	Likely significant effect on European Sites	Site screened in or out?
	Coasts		coastal fringe. The policy also goes on to state that development will not be considered in rural areas if it would undermine the character and environment of the area. - In Chapter 12 of the Plan called 'People and Place' there is a section that focuses on 'Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment' and within this is Policy CS18 on 'Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment' that recognises the importance of designated sites and includes measures for protecting and enhancing biodiversity. - The policies of other local authorities in the area to promote tourism could possibly have cumulative effects in terms of additional visitor activity and potential disturbance, but this has not been measured and the impact is uncertain. Notwithstanding this the Core Strategies of other local authorities recognise the potential for such cumulative effects and have included policies and provisions for protecting sites and conserving and where possible enhancing biodiversity.	
Farne Islands (SPA)	Qualifying features 1.9% of the GB breeding population of Common tern <i>Sterna hirundo</i> 6.5% of the GB breeding population of Arctic tern <i>Sterna paradisaea</i> 14.8% of the GB breeding population of Sandwich tern <i>Sterna sandvicensis</i> Conservation Objectives To maintain, in favourable condition, the habitats for the populations of migratory bird species of European importance and breeding seabird assemblage of European importance	Key Environmental Conditions - The majority of the site is shingle, sea cliffs, islets with some area of improved grassland and small areas of sand dunes and inland water. Site Vulnerability - The thin soils on the island are easily disturbed by erosion. - Marine activities including inshore fishing, recreation and pleasure craft are currently being monitored to assess any potential impact within the SPA.	Policy Options in the Plan are unlikely to have direct effects but tourism initiatives could help to increase activity in general area. The Plan includes Policy CS8 'Leisure, Culture and Tourism'. The implementation of such a policy may result in additional traffic and associated disturbance in the general North East area. At this stage this is a strategic general policy with a statement of intent that is not site-specific, however the policy does state that developments will be focused primarily within the Urban Core. This will encourage the focus of movement, tourism activity and footfall within this urban area as opposed to the wider coastal fringe. The policy also goes	Screened out

Site	Qualifying Features and Conservation Objectives	Key Environmental Conditions Supporting Site Integrity and Site Vulnerability	Likely significant effect on European Sites	Site screened in or out?
	with particular reference to offshore islands. Subject to natural change, to maintain in a favourable condition the reefs the partially submerged sea caves and their communities and the habitats for the grey seal in particular the extent and suitability of breeding habitat on the Farn Islands.		on to state that development will not be considered in rural areas if it would undermine the character and environment of the area. • Marine activities including inshore fishing, recreation and pleasure craft are currently being monitored by the National Trust in collaboration with Natural England to assess any potential impact within the SPA.	
Ford (SAC)	Qualifying features Active raised bogs. Conservation Objectives To maintain in favourable condition the raised bogs.	Key Environmental Conditions • The site is a largely intact 46ha bog in undulating topography in the rain shadow of the Cheviot Hills. Site Vulnerability • The site is vulnerable to drying out.	• The main pressures (in this case primarily the risk of drying out) will not be triggered by policies within the Plan. • No significant effects on this SAC anticipated.	Screened out
Harbottle Moors (SAC)	Qualifying features European dry heaths. Conservation Objectives To maintain in favourable condition the European dry heaths.	Key Environmental Conditions • Carboniferous rocks, species rich suggesting un-intensive management history. Site Vulnerability • Main pressures to the site are from managed burns and accidental wildfires set off by military activities.	• The main pressures (in this case primarily the risks of managed moor burns) will not be triggered by policies within the Plan. • No significant effects on this SAC anticipated.	Screened out
Holburn Lake and Moss SPA and Ramsar Site	Qualifying features Lowland raised mire 2.2% of the population of Greylag goose Anser anser. Inland roost for wildfowl during unfavourable weather conditions. Conservation Objectives	Key Environmental Conditions • Removal of plantation woodland and ditch damming to maintain the hydrological integrity of the site. Site Vulnerability • Maintaining the hydrological quality of the site.	• The main pressures (in this case primarily impacts on the hydrological integrity of the site) will not be triggered by policies within the Plan. • Plan policies should not affect conditions such as the hydrology of this site nor the viable populations of grey lag geese so there are no significant adverse effects anticipated on this SPA.	Screened out

Site	Qualifying Features and Conservation Objectives	Key Environmental Conditions Supporting Site Integrity and Site Vulnerability	Likely significant effect on European Sites	Site screened in or out?
Lindisfarne (SPA) and Ramsar Site	To maintain in favourable condition the Lowland raised mire and conditions for bird communities. Qualifying features Little tern <i>Sterna albifrons</i> Roseate tern <i>Sterna dougallii</i> Whooper swan <i>Cygnus cygnus</i> Bar-tailed godwit <i>Limosa lapponica</i> Golden plover <i>Pluvialis apricaria</i> Wigeon <i>Anas penelope</i> Greylag goose <i>Anser anser</i> Pale-bellied brent goose <i>Branta bernicla hrota</i> Sanderling <i>Calidris alba</i> Dunlin <i>Calidris alpina alpina</i> Ringed plover <i>Charadrius hiaticula</i> Long-tailed duck <i>Clangula hyemalis</i> Red-breasted serrat <i>Mergus serrator</i> Grey plover <i>Pluvialis squatarola</i> Common eider <i>Somateria mollissima</i> Shelduck <i>Tadorna tadorna</i> Conservation Objectives To maintain in favourable condition the habitats for the above qualifying features.	Key Environmental Conditions - Mixed landscape of barrier beach, cliffs, intertidal sediment and rocks, islands, open coast and pools. - The predominant area is tidal rivers, estuaries, mud and sand flats and lagoons. Site Vulnerability - The principle threats from humans are water quality problems (from sewage discharges and agricultural run-off), wildfowling and recreational disturbance including bait-digging.	- Policies within the Plan do not promote development at any site where the qualifying features (internationally important bird species) of this SPA are known to roost or feed and which are crucial in supporting their population viability within the SPA at Lindisfarne. - The main pressures summarised under "Site Vulnerability" are unlikely to be triggered by any policies within the Plan. - No significant effects on this SPA are anticipated.	Screened out
Newham (SAC)	Qualifying features Alkaline fens Conservation Objectives To maintain in favourable conditions the Alkaline fens.	Key Environmental Conditions - Lowland short sedge fen, a basin fen developed from hydroseral succession of a small lake. Site Vulnerability - Scrub and woodland encroachment of the fen - Adequate water level and quality Key Environmental Conditions - Coastal sand dunes and sand beaches,	- The main pressures are unlikely to be triggered by policies within the Plan. - The site vulnerability will be more determined by current management regimes, farming practices adopted by those farming the surrounding land and engineering works carried out by Network rail. - No significant effects on this SAC are anticipated as a result of the implementation of the Plan. - No direct or indirect significant effects from the Plan predicted for this SPA.	Screened out
Northumbria Coast (SPA)	Qualifying features Internationally important populations of	Key Environmental Conditions Coastal sand dunes and sand beaches,	No direct or indirect significant effects from the Plan predicted for this SPA.	Screened out

Site	Qualifying Features and Conservation Objectives	Key Environmental Conditions Supporting Site Integrity and Site Vulnerability	Likely significant effect on European Sites	Site screened in or out?
and Ramsar Site	regularly occurring Annex 1 (Little tern <i>Sterna albibifrons</i>) and migratory bird species (Turnstone <i>Arenaria interpres</i> and Purple Sandpiper <i>Calidris maritima</i>) Conservation Objectives include: To maintain in favourable condition the habitats for the above qualifying features. To also include the intertidal mudflats, sand dunes, coastal waters, reefs, rocky shores with associated boulder and cobble beaches and artificial high tide roost sites.	machair and predominantly shingle, sea cliffs and inlets. - Shallow inshore waters. - Rocky shores with associated boulder and cobble beaches. - Artificial high tide roost sites. Site Vulnerability - Rocky reef and sea cave communities are sensitive to operations that may result in their damage or removal e.g. from trawling, dredging, anchoring and coastal development or from contamination by oil or sewage. - Features found on sand and mud flats such as eel grass and mussel beds and associated animals that live in the sediment are sensitive to removal activities as above. - Threats to all of this can also come from recreational use, fisheries and waste water discharges. - Little terns are vulnerable to disturbance from tourists in the summer leading to reduced breeding success.	- No damage, removal or significant negative effects would be anticipated as a result of the implementation of policies on the following components of key habitats: - reefs, rocky shores, cobble beaches and high tide roosts; - sand and mud flats, eel grass and mussel beds. - The Plan includes Policy CS8 'Leisure, Culture and Tourism'. The implementation of such a policy may result in additional traffic and associated disturbance in the general North East area. At this stage this is a strategic general policy with a statement of intent that is not site-specific, however the policy does state that developments will be focused primarily within the Urban Core. This will encourage the focus of movement, tourism activity and footfall within this urban area as opposed to the wider coastal fringe. The policy also goes on to state that development will not be considered in rural areas if it would undermine the character and environment of the area. - In Chapter 12 of the Plan called 'People and Place' there is a section that focuses on 'Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment' and within this is Policy CS18 on 'Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment' that recognises the importance of designated sites and includes measures for protecting and enhancing biodiversity. - The policies of other local authorities in the area to promote tourism could possibly have cumulative effects in terms of additional visitor activity and potential disturbance, but this has not been measured and the impact is uncertain. Notwithstanding this the Core Strategies of other local authorities recognise	

Site	Qualifying Features and Conservation Objectives	Key Environmental Conditions Supporting Site Integrity and Site Vulnerability	Likely significant effect on European Sites	Site screened in or out?
North Northumberland Dunes (SAC)	Qualifying features Embryonic shifting dunes Shifting dunes along the shoreline with <i>Ammophila arenaria</i> ('white dunes') Fixed dunes with herbaceous vegetation ('grey dunes') Dunes with <i>Salix repens ssp. argentea</i> (<i>Salicion arenariae</i>) Humid dune slacks Petalwort <i>Petalophyllum ralfsii</i> Conservation Objectives Subject to natural change, to maintain, in favourable condition, the above features. To also include the intertidal mud and sandflats not covered by sea water at low tide.	Key Environmental Conditions - Extensive and varied vegetation. - This is an active site with extensive calcareous fixed dunes locally grading into more acidic fixed dune vegetation and dune heath. - Calcareous dunes and mature slacks contributing to a wide range of habitats. - Well-developed dune slack vegetation on the East Coast of England. - Active slack formation showing a range of successional stages and exceptional range of humid dune slack types. Site Vulnerability - Principal pressures on the site include insufficient grazing management in some areas and damage by over intensive overwintering of cattle and sheep in others. - Invasion by the non- native plant <i>Acaena novae-zealandinae</i> is a problem in some areas. - English Nature is working with the local authorities and site managers to address the impact of recreational activities on the dunes, which can be localised.	the potential for such cumulative effects and have included policies and provisions for protecting sites and conserving and where possible enhancing biodiversity. (See Chapter 3 for further discussion) - No direct or indirect significant effects from the Plan predicted for this SAC. No damage, removal or significant negative effects would be anticipated as a result of the implementation of policies on the following components of key habitats that make up this SAC: - dune vegetation and dune heath; - dune slacks; - embryonic shifting dunes; - calcareous or acid fixed dunes. - The Plan includes Policy CS8 'Leisure, Culture and Tourism'. The implementation of such a policy may result in additional traffic and associated disturbance in the general North East area. At this stage this is a strategic general policy with a statement of intent that is not site-specific, however the policy does state that developments will be focused primarily within the Urban Core. This will encourage the focus of movement, tourism activity and footfall within this urban area as opposed to the wider coastal fringe. The policy also goes on to state that development will not be considered in rural areas if it would undermine the character and environment of the area. - In Chapter 12 of the Plan called 'People and Place' there is a section that focuses on 'Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment' and within this is Policy CS18 on 'Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment' that recognises the importance of designated sites and includes measures for protecting and enhancing biodiversity.	Screened out

Site	Qualifying Features and Conservation Objectives	Key Environmental Conditions Supporting Site Integrity and Site Vulnerability	Likely significant effect on European Sites	Site screened in or out?
			The policies of other local authorities in the area to promote tourism could possibly have cumulative effects in terms of additional visitor activity and potential disturbance, but this has not been measured and the impact is uncertain. Notwithstanding this the Core Strategies of other local authorities recognise the potential for such cumulative effects and have included policies and provisions for protecting sites and conserving and where possible enhancing biodiversity.	
North Pennine Dale Meadow (SAC)	Qualifying features Mountain hay meadows <i>Molinia meadows</i> Conservation Objectives To maintain, in favourable condition, the: Mountain hay meadows	Key Environmental Conditions - Calcareous, peaty or clayey-silt-laden soils (<i>Molinia caerulea</i>). - Isolated fields within several north Pennine and Cumbrian valleys. - Grasslands exhibiting very limited effects of agricultural improvement and show good conservation of structure and function. Site Vulnerability - These grasslands are dependent on traditional agriculture techniques which are no longer economic, management agreements and ESA payments are being used to promote the continuation of traditional management.	- The main pressures (in this case primarily current agricultural practices) will not be triggered by policies within the Plan. - The Plan would not be expected to generate significant adverse effects on this SAC.	Screened out

Site	Qualifying Features and Conservation Objectives	Key Environmental Integrity and Vulnerability	Conditions Supporting Site	Likely significant effect on European Sites	Site screened in or out?
North Pennine Moors (SAC)	Annex I habitats present - European dry heaths <i>Juniperus communis</i> formations on heaths or calcareous grasslands - Blanket bogs * Priority feature - Petrifying springs with tufa formation (<i>Cratoneurion</i>) Priority feature - Siliceous rocky slopes with <i>chasmophytic</i> vegetation - Old sessile oak woods with <i>Ilex</i> and <i>Blechnum</i> in the British Isles - Northern Atlantic wet heaths with <i>Erica tetralix</i> - Calaminarian grasslands of the <i>Violetalia calaminariae</i> - Siliceous alpine and boreal grasslands - Semi-natural dry grasslands and scrubland facies: on calcareous substrates (<i>Festuco-Brometalia</i>) - Alkaline fens - Siliceous scree of the montane to snow levels (<i>Androsacetalia alpinae</i>) and (<i>Galeopsietalia ladani</i>) - Calcareous rocky slopes with <i>chasmophytic</i> vegetation Annex II species present Marsh saxifrage <i>Saxifraga hirculus</i>	Key Environmental Integrity and Vulnerability - Appropriate controlled grazing - Sympathetic burning regimes - Limited air pollution (Acid and nitrogen deposition continue to have damaging effects on the site.) - No drainage of wet areas - Maintenance of water levels		- The main pressures will not be triggered by policies within the Plan. - The Plan would not be expected to generate significant adverse effects on this SAC.	Screened out

Site	Qualifying Features and Conservation Objectives	Key Environmental Conditions Supporting Site Integrity and Vulnerability	Likely significant effect on European Sites	Site screened in or out?
North Pennine Moors (SPA)	Annex I species that are a primary reason for selection of this site: Hen Harrier, Merlin, Peregrine Falcon, Golden Plover	Key Environmental Conditions and Site Vulnerability - Grazing to maintain suitable moorland - Control of erosion and peat extraction - Diversity, age and structure of vegetation - Food availability - Open landscape - Lack of disturbance and persecution	- It is unlikely that the main pressures will be triggered by policies within the Plan, and thus the Plan would not be expected to generate significant adverse effects on this SAC. - It has been suggested that the population of golden plovers that breeds on the moors could be one that relies on mudflats on the River Tyne in Gateshead for feeding, and could thus become disturbed by tourism developments that increase the use of the river near these feeding grounds. However current observations on the golden plovers using these mudflats suggests that they are not connected to the SPA but are birds coming directly from Scandinavia (See Chapter 3 for further discussion).	Screened out
River Tweed (SAC)	Qualifying Features Annex I Habitat Water courses of plain to montane levels with the <i>Ranunculus fluitantis</i> and <i>Callitriche-Batrachion</i> vegetation Alluvial forests with <i>Alnus glutinosa</i> and <i>Fraxinus excelsior</i> (Alno-Padion, Alnion incanae, Salicetion albae) Annex II Species Atlantic salmon <i>Salmo salar</i> Otter <i>Lutra lutra</i> Sea lamprey <i>Petromyzon marinus</i> Brook lamprey <i>Lampetra planeri</i> River lamprey <i>Lampetra fluviatilis</i>	Key Environmental Conditions - Tidal rivers, estuaries, mud flats, sand flats, lagoons and inland waters (standing and running). Bogs, marshes, water fringed vegetation, fens and broad leaved deciduous woodland Site Vulnerability - The main impacts on the river are from pollution, acidification and eutrophication, river-works and bankside management, genetic pollution and disease, abstraction and impoundment management. - Increased nutrient inputs from arable farming.	- The main pressures will not be triggered by policies within the Plan. - The Plan would not be expected to generate significant adverse effects on this SAC.	Screened out

Site	Qualifying Features and Conservation Objectives	Key Environmental Conditions Supporting Site Integrity and Site Vulnerability	Likely significant effect on European Sites	Site screened in or out?
	Conservation Objectives To maintain in favourable conditions the estuaries, mudflats and sandflats.			
Simonside Hills (SAC)	Qualifying features European dry heaths (one of UK's best areas) Blanket bogs (a significant presence). Conservation Objectives To maintain, in favourable condition the heather moorland and blanket bog, which are habitats of national importance and also part of a European network of key sites.	Key Environmental Conditions - Predominantly heath, scrub, marquis and garrigue and phygrana. - Some bog, marshes, fens and water fringed vegetation and some broad-leaved deciduous woodland. Site Vulnerability - Blanket bog is particularly vulnerable to burning. Active drains on the blanket bog are currently affecting the hydrology of the mire and the species composition, these grips are planned to be blocked. - Significant erosion from footpaths. Bracken and rhododendron are a problem.	- The main pressures will not be triggered by policies within the Plan. - The Plan would not be expected to generate significant adverse effects on this SAC.	Screened out
Tweed Estuary (SAC)	Qualifying Features Estuaries, mudflats and sandflats not covered by seawater at low tide Sea lamprey <i>Petromyzon marinus</i> River lamprey <i>Lampetra fluviatilis</i> Conservation Objectives To maintain in favourable conditions the estuaries, mudflats and sandflats.	Key Environmental Conditions - Long narrow estuary, which is largely natural and undisturbed, with its water quality classified as excellent throughout. Site Vulnerability - Increased nutrient inputs from arable farming.	- The main pressures will not be triggered by policies within the Plan. - The Plan would not be expected to generate significant adverse effects on this SAC.	Screened out

ANNEX D
OTHER RELEVANT STRATEGIES
AND PLANS

Table D1 Other Relevant Strategies/Plans – Potential for In-Combination Effects

Local Authority or Agency/Organisation	Other Relevant Objectives/Policies in Respective Core Strategies	Policies Protecting European Sites	Policies Protecting Other Designated Sites, Green Infrastructure, Habitats and Nature in General	Sources of Information
Durham County Council	The Council seeks to create 23,000 new jobs in County Durham and increase the proportion of its workforce that is in work to 73% from 66%; increase the numbers of visitors and the amount of time and money they spend in the county; and ensure there is an accessible, integrated and sustainable transport system. It also seeks to ensure that new development is focused on the county's 12 main towns, while ensuring all settlements have a sustainable future, while protecting and enhancing the natural, built and historic environment.	- Policy 37: North Pennines Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty - Policy 38: Durham Coast and Heritage Coast - Policy 42: Internationally Designated Sites	- Policy 20: Green Infrastructure - Policy 27: Visitor Attractions - Policy 28: Visitor Accommodation - Policy 35: Development in the Countryside	The County Durham Plan: Pre-submission Draft Local Plan, October 2013 Website: www.durham.gov.uk
Northumberland County Council²⁰	The Council supports the growth and quality of Northumberland based jobs, focussing on the service, creative and tourism and accommodation related sectors. Renewable energy, manufacturing and offshore developments around the Blyth estuary are also being promoted as well as continued support for small businesses. Housing and development allocations are also being considered in existing green belt boundaries. A full HRA will be performed on a consolidated draft plan in 2014 to gauge the effect of proposed policies on European sites of nature conservation interest, it is stated however that the Council must ensure that the Core Strategy does not have any adverse effects on such sites.	- Policy 3: North Northumberland Delivery Area - Policy 5: Central Northumberland Delivery Area - Policy 37: Large-scale wind energy development - Policy 45: Ports, harbours and beach launch facilities - Policy 51c: Natural environment	- Policy 1: Sustainable Development - Policy 2d: Spatial Distribution - Policy 51a,b,d: Natural environment - Policy 52: Landscape - Policy 54: Green infrastructure - Green Belt boundary being identified at next version of Core Strategy	Northumberland Local Plan: Core Strategy Preferred Options for Housing, Employment and Green Belt, Consultation Document October 2013 Northumberland Local Plan: Core Strategy Preferred Options, Consultation Document February 2013 Website: www.northumberland.gov.uk
North Tyneside Council	The Council seeks to diversify, strengthen and grow the local economy. Plans will maximise the area's potential, especially in the coastal and riverside areas, and support tourism and its related services as these are an important aspect of the North Tyneside economy. Significant potential exists for its further development in a number of locations within the Borough. The coastal strip between St. Mary's Lighthouse and Tynemouth is already established as a visitor attraction both in terms of the natural	- AS/1.5 The Coastal Sub Area - S/8.4 Biodiversity and Geodiversity - DM/8.5 Managing Impacts upon Biodiversity and Geodiversity	- S/3.1 The Green Belt - DM/3.2 Development with the Green Belt - S/8.1 Strategic Green Infrastructure - DM/8.2 Protection of Green Infrastructure - DM/8.3 Green Space Provision and Standards	North Tyneside Local Plan: Consultation Draft North Tyneside Council, November 2013 Website: www.northtyneside.gov.uk

²⁰ Given that the Core Strategy of the relatively recently formed Northumberland County Council is not yet complete (Housing, Employment and Green Belt section is out for consultation at the time of writing), this table relies on previous information from the Northumberland Core Strategy Preferred Options 2 - October 2013 document. A full draft Core Strategy will be published in early 2014

Local Authority or Agency/Organisation	Other Relevant Objectives/Policies in Respective Core Strategies	Policies Protecting European Sites	Policies Protecting Other Designated Sites, Green Infrastructure, Habitats and Nature in General	Sources of Information
	environment and maritime - related leisure. Similarly, the North Bank of the Tyne River is to be regenerated with marine related industries and training and pave the way for heritage-led regeneration of North Shields Fish Quay which will also increase tourist potential. In view of this significance of tourism, the Draft Local Plan contains strategic policies aiming to: • Maximise the benefits of tourism, both for visitors to the area and also for the community as a whole • Avoid adverse impact of tourism development and facilities • Integrate tourism - related development with its surroundings, both in terms of design, layout and relationship with existing services and infrastructure • Identify general locations within the Borough where tourism development will be encouraged and promoted • Protect and enhance the natural, built and heritage environment		• DM/8.8 Trees and Woodland • AS/8.9 Key Green Spaces in Wallsend and Willington Quay	
South Tyneside Council ²¹	The Council will encourage developments, which promote new enterprise and encourage the development of culture, tourism and hospitality.	• Policy EA2: The Coastal Zone • Policy EA3: Biodiversity and Geodiversity	• Policy SC6: Providing for Recreational Open Space, Sport and Leisure • Policy EA4: World Heritage Sites • Policy EA5: Environmental Protection • Policy ST1: Spatial Strategy for South Tyneside • Policy ST2: Sustainable Urban Living	South Tyneside Local Development Framework Core Strategy (2007). Website: www.southtyneside.info

²¹ Core Strategy has not been updated since the 2007 information used

Local Authority or Agency/Organisation	Other Relevant Objectives/Policies in Respective Core Strategies	Policies Protecting European Sites	Policies Protecting Other Designated Sites, Green Infrastructure, Habitats and Nature in General	Sources of Information
Sunderland City Council	Economic regeneration, tourism (including regeneration of the Seafront) and social regeneration are key focuses for the Borough and accordingly land has been assigned to each type of development. Environment has been identified as one of Sunderland's key assets – both historic and natural heritage. Green corridors are to be created and promoted using the Green Belt as a base. 90% of land allocated to settlement breaks is recommended to be retained.	Policy CS7.7: Caring for the City's Environment	- Policy CS3: Developing the City's Economic Prosperity - Policy CS7: Caring for the City's Environment	Sunderland Local Plan: Core Strategy and Development Management Policies Draft Revised Preferred Options, August 2013 Website: www.sunderland.gov.uk
Environment Agency	The Environment Agency proposes to take further action to reduce flood risk in the Tyne area due to its long history of flooding and recent development proposals. It cites a partnership approach with the relevant authorities to ensure all future developments within the policy unit are appropriate and reduce surface water runoff, where appropriate, and delivering integrated and co-ordinated flood risk management. This has been reflected in the Plan via the incorporation of SuDS measures where possible.	n/a	n/a	Tyne Catchment Flood Management Plan: Policies and measures for managing flood risk Ouseburn policy unit, Revision 2 January 2012 Website: www.environment-agency.gov.uk

Table D2 Potential for Cumulative or In-Combination Effects and Mitigation

Key Issues	Causes	Cumulative and/or Synergistic Effects	Affected Receptor	Influence of the Plan	Potential mitigation
Threats to Designated Areas for Nature Conservation and possible loss of biodiversity and geodiversity	Depending on location development of sites for housing, retail, business premises, new leisure, recreational and tourism facilities, transport infrastructure and utilities. Development within the Urban Core near to the River Tyne and also the Tyne estuary, plus any development that threatens feeding and roosting sites of migratory birds could put pressure on areas of international (SPA), national (SSSIs) and local conservation importance.	There will be the potential to disturb, remove and replace habitats and associated flora and fauna (possibly including protected species) at the sites of development and then depending on their location there could be indirect negative impacts on nearby sites of conservation importance (disturbance, downstream contamination etc). There may also be risks of possible fragmentation of habitats and destruction or interruption of wildlife corridors. Development on the River Tyne and in and around the Tyne Estuary could put pressure on the Northumbrian Coast Ramsar site and SPA. An indirect effect of further development in and around these areas, particularly tourism developments could be associated increases in traffic and the disturbing impacts that this could have on biodiversity. A cumulative effect of further office and housing development within the Urban Core could be the additional construction of road and other infrastructure that would arise as a consequence of the development.	- Land take - Biodiversity (flora and fauna) - Public amenity - Local residents and communities	Additional housing and growth of businesses and commercial operations, including retail and recreational facilities with associated transport infrastructure could lead to a reduction in biodiversity (particularly for large developments along the River Tyne or in the Ouseburn area). The influence of the Plan could be beneficial if policies designed to protect the natural environment (such as Policy CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment) are used vigorously not only to protect biodiversity but also to enhance it.	The Plan Policies Application of Policies CS15 (Place Making) and CS18 (Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment) with specific measures to promote sustainable design and protect green infrastructure and the natural environment, should help to mitigate against any potentially negative effects that Urban Core development policies might have. Policy UC15 (Urban Green Infrastructure) offers some more protection for green infrastructure and therefore indirectly for biodiversity as well. Neighbouring Authority Core Strategy Policies A number of neighbouring local authorities have drafted policies to protect and enhance biodiversity and it is anticipated that these too would in-combination reinforce the necessary mitigation. It would also be expected that wildlife conservation legislation that exists as acts of parliament or that has been developed through the implementation of European Directives should also provide for adequate protection, particularly of designated sites and protected species.

Key Issues	Causes	Cumulative and/or Synergistic Effects	Affected Receptor	Influence of the Plan	Potential mitigation
Water Resources (water use and water quality impacts)	Development that leads to increases in the number of houses and commercial premises, on the scale anticipated in the Plan is likely to lead to an increased demand for water and wastewater treatment. There will be a requirement to make sure that wastewater is treated to acceptable levels in order to safeguard the quality of controlled waters (surface groundwater) and to make sure that there is no deterioration in amenity value of the Urban Core's rivers and watercourses (mainly the River Tyne and the Ouseburn). There may also be issues with regard to surface water management around developments during construction and thereafter. The Urban Core has been identified as an area of risk from surface water flash flooding. The need to adapt to the effects of climate	Increases in the pollution load to sewage treatment works could put pressure on operations and the water quality of receiving waters. There may be additional risks for surface and groundwater. If more infrastructure is needed to supply and treat water, this could put costs up for the water company and in turn for the consumer. More urban development with roads, paving and infrastructure could lead to more run-off, some of this can pick up pollutants from road use and maintenance that could affect the quality of receiving waters.	- Controlled waters (rivers, groundwaters and coastal waters) - Habitats and biodiversity - Water companies - Consumers.	Housing and business growth (e.g. offices, retail, leisure, cultural and tourism) in the Urban Core will lead to increased water consumption and the amount of wastewater generated that could put pressure on current capacity. The Plan includes proposed developments located on the riverside (the River Tyne) and within another small river catchment (the Ouseburn) and these developments could have a cumulative impact on water quality. The Plan places an emphasis on protecting the natural environment of Gateshead and Newcastle (Policy CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment) and there are policies that incorporate the principles of sustainable design and specifically the protection of the River Tyne (Policies CS15: Place Making and CS17: Flood Risk and Water Management). The Plan also places an emphasis on protecting the natural environment and in sections on green infrastructure and climate change includes reference to protecting the ecological value of the River Tyne and the role that green infrastructure can play in water management.	The Plan Policies Application of Policies CS15 (Place Making), CS16 (Climate Change), CS17 (Flood Risk and Water Management) and CS18 (Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment), should in the first instance prevent these effects and should also mitigate against the possible negative impacts. Neighbouring Authority Core Strategy Policies A number of neighbouring local authorities have drafted policies to protect and safeguard water resources and it is anticipated that these too would in-combination reinforce the necessary mitigation. Existing water pollution control legislation implemented under the Water Framework Directive, primarily by the Environment Agency should also provide for adequate protection. See also Section 3. 3 for additional discussion.

Key Issues	Causes	Cumulative and/or Synergistic Effects	Affected Receptor	Influence of the Plan	Potential mitigation
	change will also have knock-on effects on water management.				

ANNEX E
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